

PREPARING FOR WINTER

There's a nip in the air this October day in 1270. The village elders have read the signs—winter will come early and be long and cold. Everyone is busy, some with harvesting the last of the corn and squash from the fields on the mesa top, others with preparing supplies and making warm clothes from animal skins. Fires will be lit inside, and drinks of tea made from herbs are served.



Ladder leading into the kiva from the plaza above

Underground kiva

Beneath each round plaza is a circular underground room known as a kiva. It was used for ceremonies and gatherings. It had a fire pit and wall benches, and could hold many people.

Pueblo pottery

The Puebloan people had made beautiful pots, bowls, and ladles for centuries. At this time, they also started producing mugs in the traditional black and white style. All mugs had their own unique geometric patterns.



Clay mug for drinking tea made of herbs



A *mano* stone is rolled over the corn, crushing it.

A figure holding its arms up, maybe in a dance.

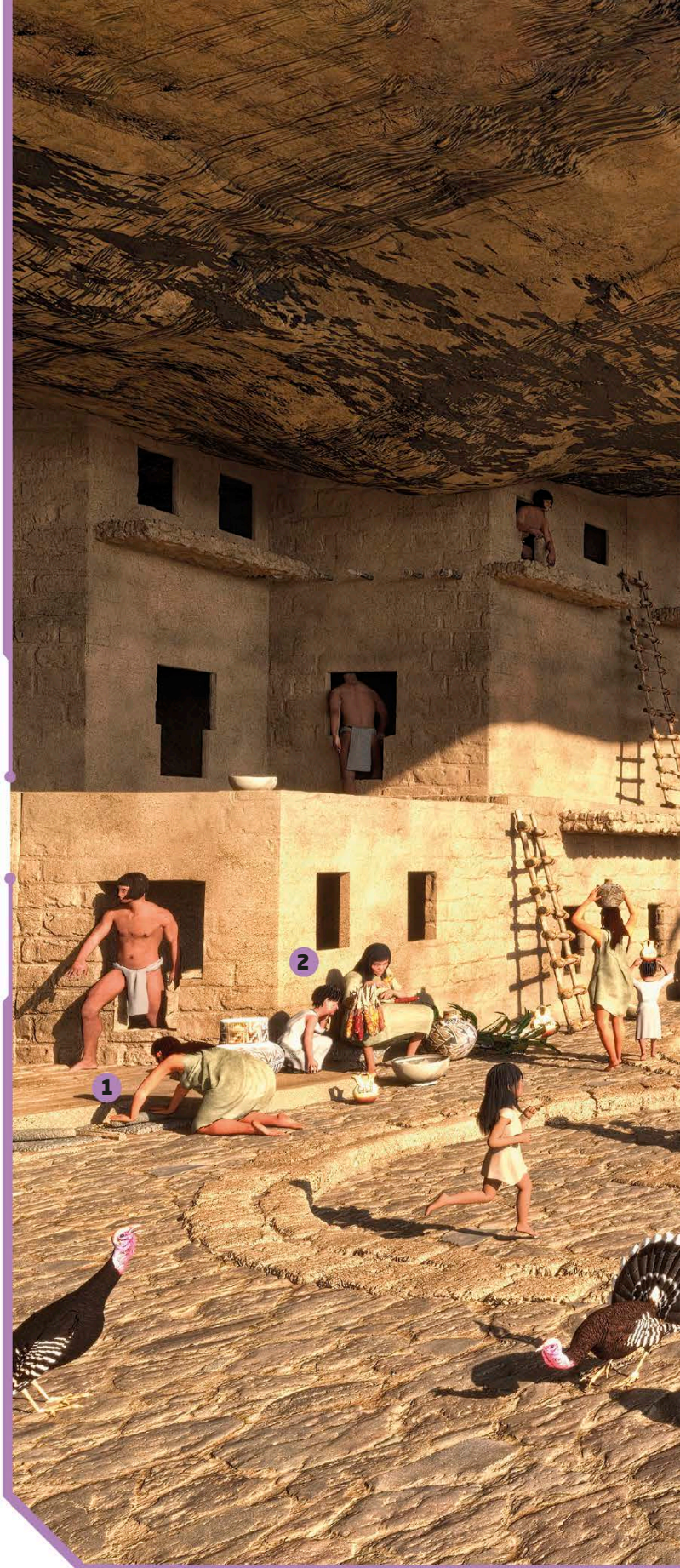
Rock art

The Puebloans carved sacred images in the soft sandstone rocks around their villages. These images illustrate stories of their origins and show animals, human figures, and sacred symbols.



Food grinder

Corn and berries were ground to flour or paste on a flat stone called a *metate*. Villages often had a row of *metates* where several women worked side by side to produce food for all.



1 Corn flour

Kneeling on the ground, this woman is busy grinding dried corn kernels into flour.

2 Good harvest

This child is watching her mother prepare the corn. Soon she'll know how to do it herself.